

DISASTER RECOVERY POLICY

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Disaster Recovery (DR) Policy

1. Purpose

The purpose of this **Disaster Recovery Policy** is to establish the framework for planning, implementing, and managing the recovery of critical IT systems, services, and data in the event of a disaster or significant disruption to operations. This policy ensures the continuity of business processes by reducing downtime, minimizing data loss, and protecting the organization's reputation, financial health, and client relationships.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all business-critical applications, data, and IT systems used by Ideas2IT, including:

- **Software systems** (development, testing, and production environments).
- **Infrastructure** (on-premises servers, cloud services, networks).
- **Employee systems** (workstations, laptops, and mobile devices).
- **Client data** and other third-party data managed by the company.
- All employees, contractors, vendors, and third parties who are involved in managing or supporting IT systems and infrastructure.

3. Definitions

- **Disaster:** Any event or incident that causes a significant disruption to normal business operations, including but not limited to hardware failure, software malfunction, cyberattacks, natural disasters, or power outages.
- **Recovery Point Objective (RPO):** The maximum amount of data loss that is acceptable in the event of a disaster. It refers to the age of the data that must be recovered.

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- **Recovery Time Objective (RTO):** The maximum allowable downtime for critical systems and applications. It defines how quickly systems must be restored after a disruption to avoid unacceptable impacts on business operations.
- **Business Continuity:** Ensuring that essential business functions continue during and after a disaster, including backup systems, communication channels, and remote work options.

4. Objectives

The objectives of this Disaster Recovery Policy are to:

- Minimize the impact of disasters on business operations and client services.
- Ensure the availability of critical systems and data as quickly as possible after a disruption.
- Protect the integrity and security of the organization's data, including customer, financial, and intellectual property data.
- Define clear roles, responsibilities, and recovery procedures for employees and teams during a disaster.
- Ensure compliance with applicable regulations and contractual requirements related to data protection, confidentiality, and disaster recovery.

5. Risk Assessment and Business Impact Analysis

- **Risk Assessment:** The organization will perform a **Risk Assessment** annually to identify potential threats to business operations (e.g., cyberattacks, hardware failure, power outages, natural disasters, human error).
- **Business Impact Analysis (BIA):** The company will conduct a **BIA** to assess the impact of each identified risk on business operations. This analysis will help prioritize recovery efforts for critical systems, applications, and processes.

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The BIA will evaluate:

- The **criticality** of various systems and applications.
- The **financial impact** of downtime.
- The **reputation damage** caused by service disruption.
- **Client contract requirements** regarding uptime and service level agreements (SLAs).

6. Disaster Recovery Strategy

Based on the outcomes of the risk assessment and BIA, the following key strategies will be implemented:

6.1 Recovery Time Objective (RTO) and Recovery Point Objective (RPO)

- **Critical Systems:** For critical business applications (e.g., client-facing applications, internal systems, and core IT infrastructure), the RTO will be **4 hours**, and the RPO will be **1 hour**.
- **Non-Critical Systems:** For less critical systems (e.g., email servers, internal documentation), the RTO will be **24 hours**, and the RPO will be **6 hours**.

6.2 Backup Strategy

- Regular **backups** of critical data, applications, and configurations will be performed and stored in both **on-premise** and **cloud** environments to ensure redundancy and protection.
- **Data Encryption:** Backup data will be encrypted both during transit and storage to protect sensitive information.
- **Backup Frequency:** Critical data will be backed up on a **daily basis**, while non-critical data may be backed up **weekly** or based on its importance.

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6.3 Data Replication and Redundancy

Where feasible, **data replication** will be implemented to ensure that critical systems and data are available in multiple locations (e.g., off-site data centers or cloud platforms) to minimize downtime in case of localized disruptions.

6.4 Disaster Recovery Sites

- **Hot Site:** A **hot site** will be maintained for key applications and systems to enable the organization to quickly restore functionality in the event of a disaster.
- **Warm Site:** A **warm site** will be used for less critical systems, with partial replication and ready-to-use infrastructure that can be activated when needed.

7. Disaster Recovery Plan (DRP)

7.1 Plan Development

The **Disaster Recovery Plan (DRP)** will document detailed recovery procedures for each business-critical system, including the following:

- Step-by-step actions to recover IT systems and applications.
- Roles and responsibilities of IT staff, disaster recovery teams, and external vendors.
- Contact information for key personnel, service providers, and third-party vendors.
- Communication protocols for informing stakeholders (employees, clients, vendors, etc.) during and after a disaster.

7.2 Plan Testing

- The DRP will be **tested** regularly, at least **once a year**, to ensure that the recovery procedures are effective and efficient.

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- Tests will include both **tabletop exercises** (simulating disaster scenarios) and **live recovery drills** (practical exercises restoring systems and data).

7.3 Plan Maintenance

- The DRP will be **reviewed** and updated at least **quarterly** or following any significant changes in business operations, technology, or organizational structure.

8. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Disaster Recovery Team:** A dedicated **Disaster Recovery Team** will be established, consisting of personnel from IT, business operations, security, legal, and communications.
 - **IT Team:** Responsible for recovering and restoring IT infrastructure, systems, and data.
 - **Business Continuity Team:** Ensures that business functions are maintained or quickly restored.
 - **Communications Team:** Manages internal and external communications during and after the disaster, including notifying clients and stakeholders.
- **Management Team:** Ensures that the DRP is aligned with organizational goals and compliance requirements and supports the execution of the recovery plan.

9. Communication Plan

- **Internal Communication:** Clear communication channels will be established to inform employees of the disaster status, recovery progress, and any changes to normal operations.
- **External Communication:** Clients, vendors, and regulatory bodies will be notified in case of significant disruptions, especially if SLAs or contractual commitments are affected.

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- Communication templates, including emails and notifications, will be pre-approved for fast deployment during a disaster.

10. Disaster Recovery Training

- All employees, especially those on the Disaster Recovery Team, will undergo **annual training** on disaster recovery procedures and their roles during a disaster.
- Employees will also receive training on how to report incidents and follow emergency protocols.

11. Compliance and Legal Considerations

- Ideas2IT will ensure compliance with relevant laws and regulations related to disaster recovery and business continuity, such as:
 - **Information Technology (Reasonable Security Practices and Procedures and Sensitive Personal Data or Information) Rules, 2011** under the **Information Technology Act, 2000** (India).
 - Industry-specific regulations, such as those for **financial data protection, healthcare data** (if applicable), and other contractual obligations related to disaster recovery.

12. Plan Review and Updates

This **Disaster Recovery Policy** and the associated **Disaster Recovery Plan (DRP)** will be reviewed at least **annually** and after any significant events, changes in business operations, or updates to compliance requirements. Updates will be communicated to all relevant stakeholders, and training will be conducted on any new procedures or technologies.

Conclusion

The implementation of this **Disaster Recovery Policy** ensures that Ideas2IT is prepared to quickly recover and continue operations in the

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face of disruptions. By following a structured recovery process, regularly testing the DRP, and providing clear communication and training, the organization can minimize downtime and maintain business continuity during critical events.